
CONSULT FOR AFRICA

Osteon Clinics

What Colleagues Need From an Orthopaedic Service

Doctors, physiotherapists and clinics that refer, and a shortlist who could / about 6 minutes

Answered in your own name

Prepared by Consult for Africa / September 2026

To answer online instead: <https://www.consultforafrica.com/osteon-referrer-survey.html>

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Lagos and Abuja, Nigeria



Consult for Africa is working with Dr Bolarinwa Akinola on how his service should be built over the next two years. Rather than design it around what we think referring doctors want, we are asking you directly. The questions are about your practice and your patients, and the least useful thing you could do is be polite.

What decides where a patient is sent (100 points)

Write a number against each line. They must add up to exactly 100.

The surgeon's skill and record with difficult cases	
What it will cost my patient	
How quickly my patient will be seen and treated	
Whether the patient comes back to me, with a letter	
The facility: theatre, sterility, aftercare	
Convenience and location for the patient	
Total, which must be 100	

Referring to Dr Bola

Tick one box on each line. There are no right answers, and anything you cannot answer belongs in the N/A column rather than being guessed.

1. I am clear about what his particular expertise is.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

2. My patients are seen quickly when I refer them.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

3. I hear back about what happened to my patient.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

4. I hear back quickly enough for it to be useful to me.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

5. My patients come back satisfied with how they were treated.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

6. I am confident about what my patient will be charged before I send them.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A



7. I would be comfortable sending him a complicated or redo case.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

8. The patient stays mine. I do not worry about losing them.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

Would you take part

9. A monthly meeting where difficult cases are discussed.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

10. Teaching or hands-on sessions.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

11. An online way to refer and follow a patient.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

12. A joint clinic at your own practice.

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree	N/A

A few more questions

How they know Dr Bola (tick one)

☐	I have referred patients to him
☐	I know him but have not referred
☐	I know of him only
☐	I have not come across him before
☐	We trained or worked together

Hip or knee patients seen per month (tick one)

☐	None
☐	1 to 2
☐	3 to 5
☐	6 to 10
☐	More than 10



Patients who travelled abroad in two years (tick one)

- ☐ None that I know of
- ☐ One or two
- ☐ Three to five
- ☐ More than five

Main reason a patient does not have the surgery (tick one)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ They cannot afford it | ☐ They are afraid of the surgery |
| ☐ They do not trust the result they will get here | ☐ They do not believe it is necessary yet |
| ☐ They cannot get a timely appointment | ☐ They are waiting to travel abroad |
| ☐ Something else | |

What they believe a private joint replacement costs (tick one)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Under 3 million naira | ☐ 3 to 5 million |
| ☐ 5 to 8 million | ☐ 8 to 12 million |
| ☐ Over 12 million | ☐ I genuinely do not know |

How their referring has changed in two years (tick one)

- ☐ I refer more than I used to
- ☐ About the same
- ☐ I refer less than I used to
- ☐ I used to refer and I stopped
- ☐ I have never referred to him

May we name them when approaching the colleagues they suggested (tick one)

- ☐ Yes, you may use my name
- ☐ Please do not use my name
- ☐ I would rather forward it to them myself

Attribution consent (tick one)

- ☐ Yes, my name may be attached to what I said
- ☐ Report my answers, but without my name
- ☐ Share the substance with Dr Bola but keep my identity with Consult for Africa only

Wants the findings (tick one)

- ☐ Yes, please send it
- ☐ No thank you



What usually happens to those patients (tick as many as apply)

- ☐ I manage them myself for as long as I can
- ☐ I refer to a named orthopaedic surgeon
- ☐ I refer to a hospital rather than a person
- ☐ I send them for physiotherapy and review
- ☐ They go abroad
- ☐ They do nothing, usually because of cost
- ☐ I am not sure what happens to them

What would make them refer more (tick as many as apply)

- ☐ A clear, fixed price my patient can plan around
- ☐ An instalment or financing option for my patients
- ☐ A letter back to me within a week, guaranteed
- ☐ A direct number that reaches the surgeon himself
- ☐ Being able to discuss a case with him before I refer
- ☐ A regular case discussion meeting I could join
- ☐ Published outcome figures I could show my patient
- ☐ A clinic where he sees patients at my own practice
- ☐ Being able to follow my patient's progress online
- ☐ Shorter waiting time to be seen
- ☐ Nothing, I already refer everything I can

In your own words

Optional, and usually the most useful part of the form.

Why their referring dropped, or stopped

Colleague they suggest we speak to (1)

Contact for colleague 1



Colleague they suggest we speak to (2)

Contact for colleague 2

Colleague they suggest we speak to (3)

Contact for colleague 3

The single biggest change

Where their orthopaedic patients actually end up

What they tell a patient asking about going abroad

What a genuinely good service would give them

Anything else

Please hand the completed form back in the envelope provided, or answer online at <https://www.consultforafrica.com/osteon-referrer-survey.html>. Thank you.